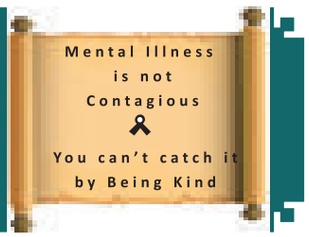
CHAPTER 10

Mental Health Nursing

Principles and Practices

மனநலம் நன்குடையார் ஆயினும் சான்றோர்க்கு
இனநலம் ஏமாப்பு உடைத்து.

"Even one has good mental strength already,
Having the company of great men will give more strength"



LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of this chapter, the students will be able to:

- define health, mental health, psychiatry, psychiatric nursing and mental illness
- enlist the characteristics of mentally healthy person
- enumerate misconceptions about the mental illness
- understand the mentally ill clients
- differentiate psychosis and neurosis
- elaborate mental disorders causes, types and management
- describe about drug abuse, alcohol abuse and management
- explain about childhood disorders like learning disabilities, ADHD and care of mentally challenged
- gain knowledge about therapeutic nurse - patient relationship
- know about the mental health services and prevention of mental illness

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Introduction

As you start to study psychiatric – mental health nursing, you may be excited and even anxious. The field of mental health often seems a little unfamiliar. The mind is about mental processes, thought and consciousness, the body is about the physical aspects of the brain – neurons and how the brain is structured.

Mental health includes our emotional, psychological and social well-being, it affects how we think, feel and act. It also helps to determine how we handle stress, relate to others and make choices. Mental health is important at every stage of life, from childhood, through adolescence to adulthood.

10.1 Terminologies

Health

The World Health Organization defines health as "a state of complete physical, mental, and social well being, not merely an absence of disease or infirmity".

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